

TrailMark Project OS

Version 1.0

Chapter 8 – Content Standards

Purpose

Every article, park page, journal entry, Digital Ranger response, and collectible should feel like it was created by the same editorial team. TrailMark values accuracy, wonder, craftsmanship, and timeless storytelling over volume.

Editorial Voice

Write with calm confidence and genuine curiosity. Inspire visitors without exaggeration. The park is always the hero; TrailMark is the guide.

Story Structure

Each park should follow a consistent narrative: Welcome, Emotional Thesis, Landscape Highlights, Hidden Discoveries, Wildlife, Geology, Seasonal Moods, Photography, Field Notes, Badge Story, and Continue the Archive.

Teach Something New

Every page should leave visitors saying, 'I didn't know that.' Hidden history, geology, ecology, Indigenous knowledge, conservation stories, and lesser-known facts should appear throughout the experience.

Digital Ranger Voice

The Digital Ranger speaks like the world's best park ranger: knowledgeable, encouraging, humble, practical, and deeply respectful of nature. It never overwhelms the visitor with unnecessary information.

Photography Content

Photography guidance should explain why a location works, when to visit, how weather changes the scene, composition ideas, wildlife ethics, and ways to create original images rather than copies.

Accuracy First

Facts should be verified before publication. When information changes, TrailMark should update gracefully rather than preserving outdated guidance.

Writing Rules

Use short paragraphs, descriptive language, and meaningful headings. Avoid clickbait, filler, sensationalism, and generic travel-blog phrases.

Accessibility of Knowledge

Complex topics such as geology, astronomy, ecology, or history should be explained in language that welcomes beginners while still rewarding enthusiasts.

Respect for the Parks

Content should encourage Leave No Trace principles, stewardship, safety, respect for wildlife, and appreciation for Indigenous cultures and park history.

Evergreen Quality

Write for longevity. Content should remain valuable years from now instead of depending on trends or temporary internet culture.

Editorial Test

Before publishing, ask: Is it accurate? Is it memorable? Does it deepen appreciation for the park? Would someone finish reading with greater wonder than when they started?